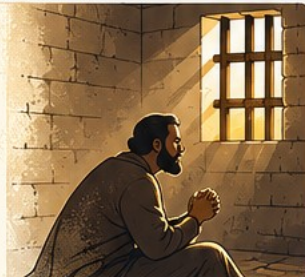




THE BACKGROUND

- Ephesus was a huge city and the epicenter of worship for many Greek and Roman gods.
- Paul spent over two years there with a very effective missionary ministry, and many people became followers of Jesus (Acts 19).
- Years later, while imprisoned by the Romans, Paul wrote this letter to the Ephesians.



1 GOD'S PURPOSE IN CHRIST | Ephesians 1

From eternity past, God planned a people, and in Christ all things are united.

ETERNITY PAST



The Father purposes to choose and bless a covenant people (Gen 12:1–3).

ADOPTION



Through Jesus, anyone can be brought into Abraham's covenant family (1:4–5).

REDEMPTION



Jesus' death covers our worst sins and failures. In him we find God's grace (1:7).

ALL THINGS UNITED UNDER CHRIST



God's purpose was to unite all things in heaven and on earth under Christ (1:10).

THE SPIRIT



The Holy Spirit brings Jew and Gentile together into one family (1:13–14).

ONE GOD — FATHER → SON → HOLY SPIRIT — ONE PURPOSE

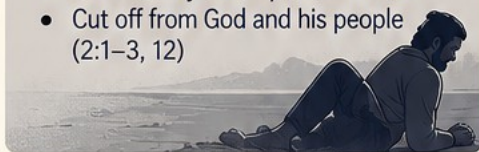
All three work together in the gospel (1:3–14).

2 FROM DEATH TO LIFE | Ephesians 2:1–10

By grace, God makes us alive with Christ and gives us a new purpose.

BEFORE CHRIST

- Spiritually dead (2:1)
- Trapped in selfishness and sin
- Deceived by dark spiritual forces
- Cut off from God and his people (2:1–3, 12)

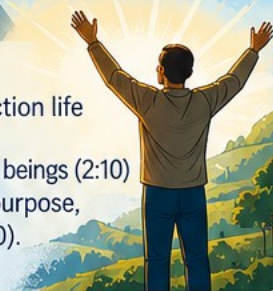


BUT GOD

In his great love and mercy, he saved us (2:4–5).

WITH CHRIST

- Forgiven (2:7)
- United to his resurrection life
- Made alive (2:5–6)
- Created as new human beings (2:10)
- Given a new calling, purpose, and works to do (2:10).



3 TWO PEOPLES — ONE NEW HUMANITY | Ephesians 2:11–22

In Christ, the barrier is removed and Jew and Gentile are made one.

JEW

God's covenant people (Abraham's family).

GENTILE

Once outsiders, cut off from God and his people.

IN CHRIST

ONE NEW HUMANITY

Living together in peace (2:14–16).

SEPARATED	→	RECONCILED
OUTSIDERS	→	FAMILY
TWO PEOPLES	→	ONE PEOPLE
HOSTILITY	→	PEACE
BARRIER	→	REMOVED
STRANGERS	→	FELLOW CITIZENS
DIVISION	→	ONE TEMPLE IN CHRIST (2:19–22)

4 PAUL'S PRAYER | Ephesians 3

Paul marvels at his role in bringing this good news to non-Jews, even while in prison. He prays that we would be strengthened by the Spirit to grasp the immense love of Christ (3:14–19).





THEREFORE ...

Because chapters 1–3 are true, chapters 4–6 follow.

The Christian life is not the way we earn the gospel.

It is the life produced by the gospel.

THE GOSPEL
CHANGES
EVERY PART
OF OUR LIFE
STORY.

1

ONE CHURCH — ONE NEW HUMANITY | Ephesians 4:1–16

The new humanity lives as one body, with many members, under Christ.

ONE
BODY
(4:4)



ONE
SPIRIT
(4:4)



ONE
HOPE
(4:4)



ONE
LORD
(4:5)



ONE
FAITH
(4:5)



ONE
BAPTISM
(4:5)



ONE
GOD
(4:6)



UNITY ≠ UNIFORMITY

- ✓ Different people.
- ✓ Different gifts.
- ✓ Different abilities.
- ✓ Same mission under one head — Christ.



A TEMPLE
BEING BUILT TOGETHER
(2:20–22; 4:11–16)

ONE SPIRIT
→ MANY GIFTS
→ ONE BODY
BUILT UP



A BODY
GROWING UNDER
CHRIST ITS HEAD
(4:15–16)



2

TAKE OFF THE OLD — PUT ON THE NEW | Ephesians 4:17–5:21

Because we are new in Christ, we walk in a new way of life.

OLD HUMANITY (4:17–19)



Lying



Anger



Stealing



Gossip



Revenge



Sexual indulgence



Drunkenness



NEW HUMANITY (4:20–5:21)



Speak truth (4:25)



Make peace, do not give the devil a foothold (4:26–27)



Be generous, work to give (4:28)



Build others up (4:29)



Forgive, be kind (4:31–32)



Self-control and purity (5:3–5)



Be filled with the Spirit (5:18), singing and thanksgiving (5:19–21)

THE IMAGE OF GOD RESTORED

The new humanity reflects God's character in truth, love, holiness, and self-giving love (4:24; 5:1–2).

3

SPIRIT-SHAPED RELATIONSHIPS | Ephesians 5:22–6:9

The gospel transforms how we live in our homes, work, and communities.



WORSHIP

Singing and thanksgiving
(5:18–21)



MARRIAGE

Husbands love as Christ loved, wives respect and submit to their husbands.
(5:22–33)



FAMILY

Children and parents
(6:1–4)



WORK / HOUSEHOLD

Servants and masters
(work relationships)
(6:5–9)

4

STAND FIRM | Ephesians 6:10–20

The new humanity has an enemy. We put on the armor of God and stand firm.



SPIRITUAL EVIL SEEKS TO:

- Undermine unity in the church.
- Draw us back toward the old life.
- Stop the mission of the new humanity.

PUT ON THE ARMOR. STAND FIRM.

- The armor imagery reflects the Messiah's own attributes (from Isaiah) that his people now put on (6:10–20).



OUR STRENGTH

In the Lord and in the strength of his might (6:10).



BIG IDEA (4–6)

BECAUSE CHRIST HAS MADE YOU NEW,
LIVE DIFFERENTLY — IN UNITY, HOLINESS, LOVE, AND MISSION.